Contracts

JULY 31, 2026



CLASSIFICATION: INTERNAL

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Overview

The Contracts module helps organizations track and manage agreements with outside vendors, service providers, and other business partners. It provides a central location to store contract details, monitor costs, and record activity related to each agreement. Labor and Parts costs can be tracked against a contract, allowing organizations to see how resources are being used and who applied those costs.

Contracts is an optional add-on module that is purchased separately from the core AIMS3 application. While not required to use AIMS3, it can be a valuable tool for managing vendor relationships, monitoring contract expenses, and helping ensure that contract terms and service agreements are being followed.

Contract information can be displayed within Equipment and Work Order records through Critical Messages. This allows technicians, supervisors, and other users to quickly review important contract details while performing their daily tasks, without requiring full access to the Contracts module.

Contract data can also be analyzed through Exports and Reports. Organizations can create custom exports to meet their specific reporting needs, while additional pre-built reports provide easy access to contract information, costs, activity history, and other important details for review and decision-making.

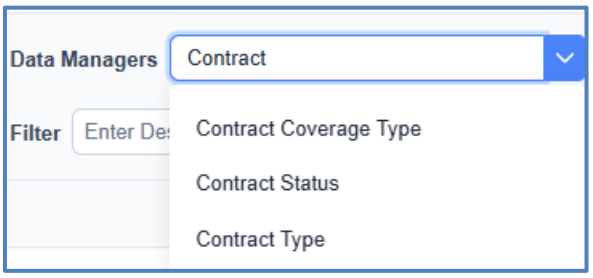
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Data Managers and System Setup

Before using the Contracts module, several supporting records and settings must be configured. These items provide the foundation needed for contracts to function correctly throughout AIMS 3.

The following Data Managers must be created before contracts can be entered into the system:

- Vendors that will be associated with contracts
- Service Departments that will manage or use contracts
- Contract Statuses used to track the stage of each contract
- Coverage Types used to define what is covered under the agreement
- Reviewers, which must be created in the Employee Data Manager



These Data Managers are required for the Contracts module and should be reviewed and completed before creating Contract records. Additionally, the settings located under System Setup → Contract Options should be reviewed and configured. These options control how the Contracts module functions within AIMS 3 and help ensure it aligns with your organization's contract management workflows and processes.

Note: To gain a better understanding of how these settings can be configured and applied within your AIMS3 application, please refer to the Data Managers and System Setup How-To Guide. This guide provides additional details and best practices for managing and maintaining these settings effectively.

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Menu Bar



Save – Allows the User to Save a Contract once the required fields have been populated.



New – Creates a new Contract.



Duplicate – Duplicates the existing Contract.



Delete – Deletes the Saved or Unsaved Contract.



Undo – Returns the Unsaved Contract to the previous save point.



First – Navigates to the first Contract record in the Contracts List.



Previous – Navigates to the previous Contract record in the Contracts List.



Next – Navigates to the previous Contract record in the Contracts List.



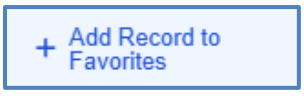
Last – Navigates to the last Contract record in the Contracts List.



Link – Copies the Contract's URL to the computer's clipboard. This can then be pasted into an email or messaging program to be sent to another User AIMS 3.



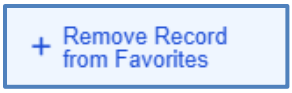
Email Link – This will open an email in the User's default email program and automatically fills in the Contract's information. This makes it quicker to complete the "Link" function above when sending the link through an email.



Add Record to Favorites – Adds the Record to the "Favorites" widget on the Home Screen. For additional information on this functionality, please visit the "Home Screen" document in the How-To's.

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Remove Record to Favorites – Removes the Record to the "Favorites" widget on the Home Screen. For additional information on this functionality, please visit the "Home Screen" document in the How-To's.





Vendor Directory – Opens the Vendor Directory and displays all available information about the Vendor. This information is added through the Data Managers component.

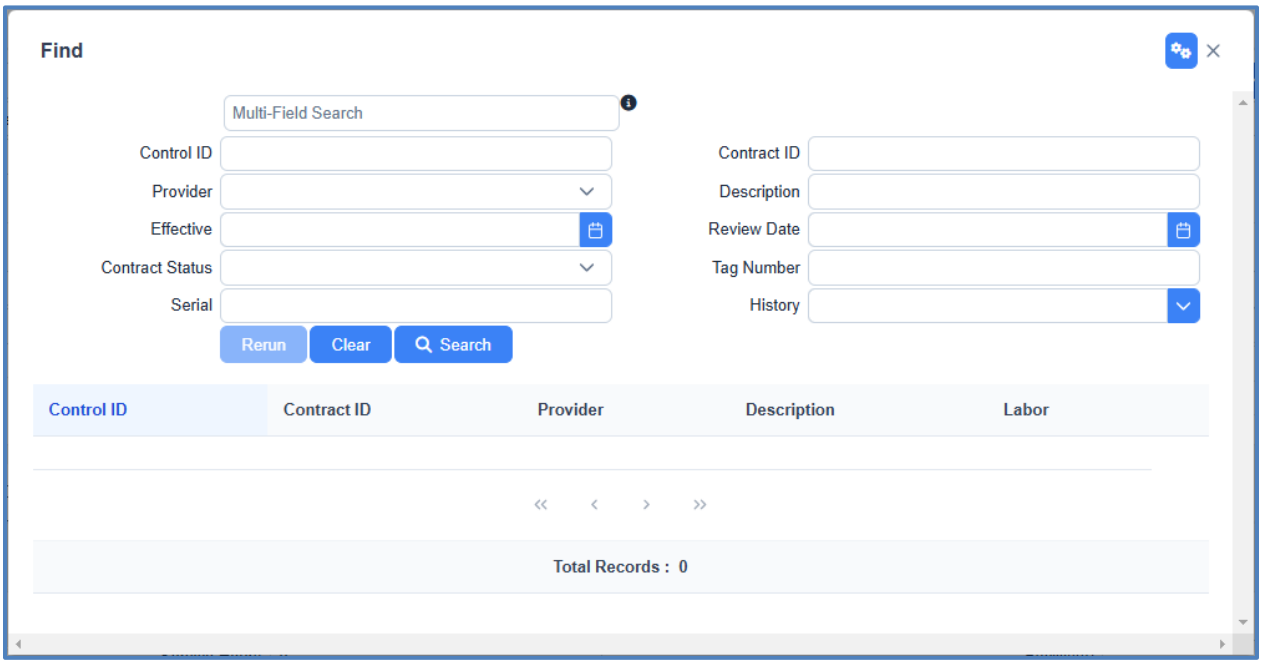


Find – Opens the Search Query screen where a single Contract record or multiple Contract records can be filtered.

The Contracts Find window allows users to search for contracts using a variety of available contract fields. After entering the desired search criteria, click the Search button to display matching contract records in the results grid at the bottom of the window.

To help save time and reduce repetitive searches, AIMS 3 stores the last ten searches performed by each user in the History section. Along with the search criteria, the History list displays the number of records returned for each search.

Users can select any search from the History list and click Rerun to perform the search again using the most current contract data. When a search is rerun, it is moved to the top of the History list rather than creating a duplicate entry, making it easy to access frequently used searches while keeping the list organized.

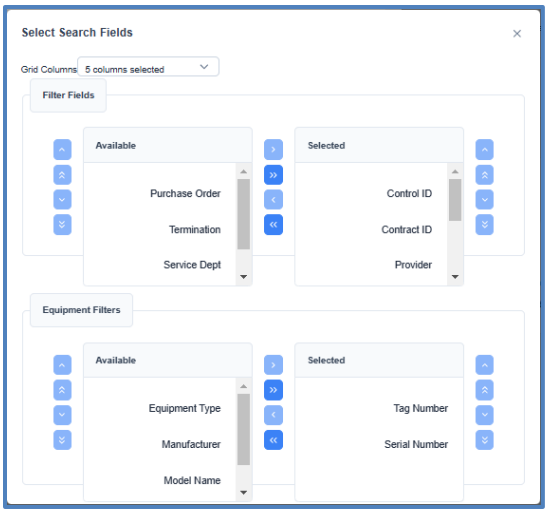


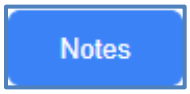
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Setup – Users can adjust which fields and grids are visible by clicking the Select Search Fields button in the upper right corner of the window.

The dropdown “Grid Columns” allows the user to change the information viewed in the results grid. The Contract Filters changes which fields the user can search. These changes are user specific.



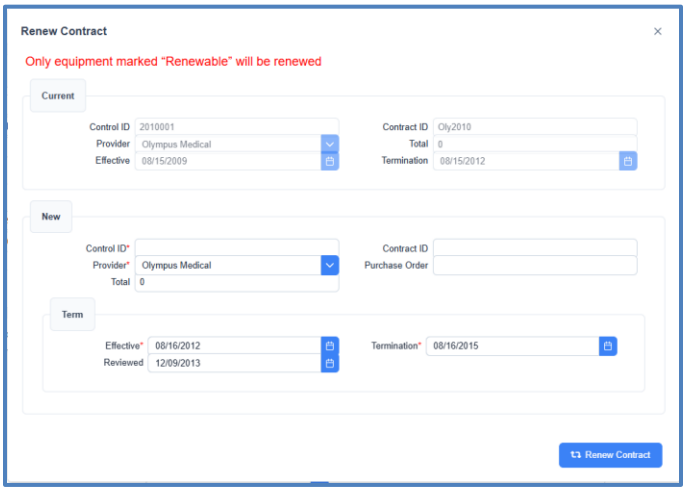


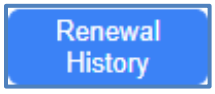
Notes – Contains notes about the Contract.



Renew Contract – Renews the Contract for all Equipment declared “Renewable”. The User will be presented with a pop to enter the new Contract’s information.

After entering the new Contract’s information, clicking the “Renew Contract” will create the new Contract. All applicable information from the original Contract will be copied to the new Contract.

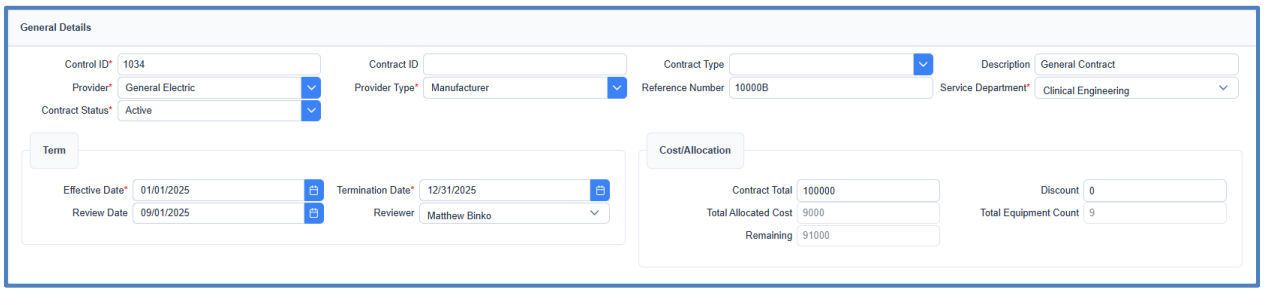




Renewal History – Opens up a Report to display how a Contract has been renewed with all previous versions of the Contract.

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General Details



The General Details section contains the primary information used to identify, manage, and track a contract throughout its lifecycle.

Control ID is the primary identification number for the contract within AIMS 3.

Contract ID is a secondary identification number that can be used for internal tracking purposes. This field is optional and is not required by the system.

Contract Type is a user-defined field that can be customized to fit your organization's contract categories and workflows.

Description provides a general summary of the contract and helps users quickly identify its purpose.

Provider identifies the Vendor associated with the contract. Vendors must be created in the Vendor Data Manager before they can be selected.

Provider Type identifies the type of contract provider. Common options include Independent Service Organization, Manufacturer, and Insurance.

Reference Number is an optional user-defined field that can be used to store an additional tracking number or reference associated with the contract.

Service Department identifies the department or departments that will utilize or manage the contract.

Contract Status displays the status of the contract. Statuses can be updated manually or automatically based on settings configured in System Setup → Contract Options.

Effective Date specifies when the contract becomes active. Once this date is reached, the contract status can automatically change from the designated Upcoming Status to the Active Status.

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Termination Date specifies when the contract expires. Once this date is reached, the contract status can automatically change from the Active Status to the Expired Status.

Review Date identifies when the contract should be reviewed. When this date is reached, the assigned reviewer(s) receive an email notification reminding them that the contract is due for review. The email includes key contract details such as the Control ID, Contract ID, Provider, Effective Date, Termination Date, Contract Total, Purchase Order Number, and a direct link to the contract record in AIMS 3.

Reviewer identifies the employee or employees responsible for reviewing the contract when the Review Date is reached.

Contract Total represents the total dollar amount available for distribution across the equipment covered by the contract.

Total Allocated Cost is a read-only field that displays the amount of the Contract Total that has already been assigned to equipment on the contract.

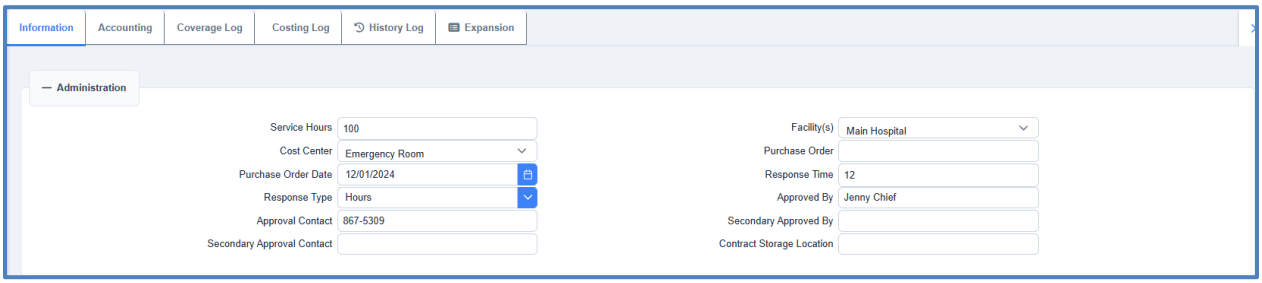
Remaining is a read-only field that displays the amount of the Contract Total that is still available for allocation.

Discount allows a discount or amount to be applied to services covered under the contract.

Total Equipment Count is a read-only field that displays the number of equipment records currently associated with the contract.

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Information Tab



Directly beneath the General Details section are six tabs that contain additional information about the contract. The first tab, Information, stores administrative details and purchasing information related to the contract.

Service Hours identifies the number of service hours included as part of the agreement.

Facility allows users to select one or more Facilities that will benefit from the contract. Multiple Facilities can be associated with a single contract when needed.

Cost Center allows users to select one or more Cost Centers that will utilize or benefit from the contract.

Purchase Order records the purchase order number used to purchase the contract.

Purchase Order Date records the date the contract was purchased.

Response Time specifies how quickly the Provider is contractually required to respond when service is requested.

Response Type defines the unit of time associated with the Response Time, such as hours or days, based on the terms of the agreement.

Approved By identifies the individual who approved the contract.

Approved Contact stores the contact information for the individual who approved the contract.

Secondary Approved By identifies an additional individual who approved or reviewed the contract.

Secondary Approval Contact stores the contact information for the secondary approver.

Contract Storage Location identifies where the physical copy of the contract is stored, making it easier for staff to locate original contract documentation when needed.

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Coverage Hours

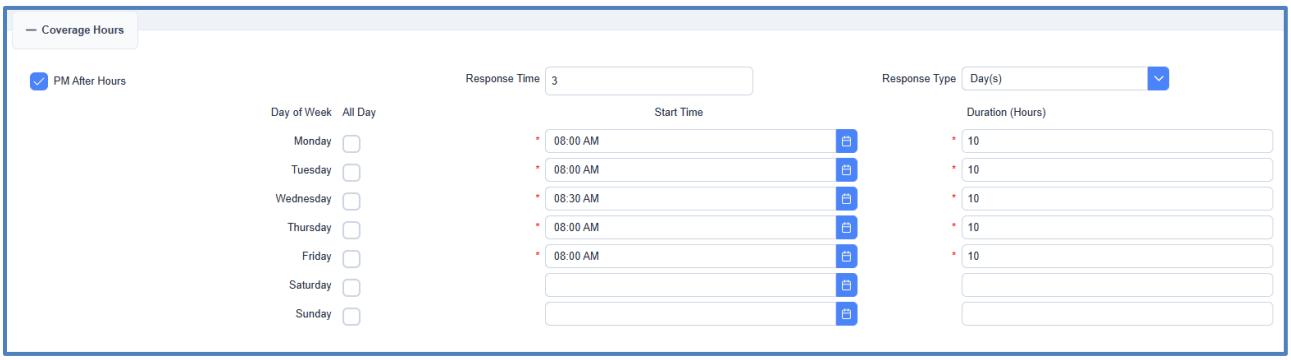
Coverage Hours allow organizations to define the specific days and times a Contract provides coverage for equipment. These hours are used throughout AIMS 3 to help determine when services, labor, and other contract-related costs should be applied. This feature is especially useful when managing vendor contracts that only provide support during designated hours.

PM After Hours - This checkbox indicates that Preventive Maintenance work orders can be performed outside of normal business hours.

Response times - This free-text field is used to specify the typical amount of time it takes a vendor to respond to a service request under the contract.

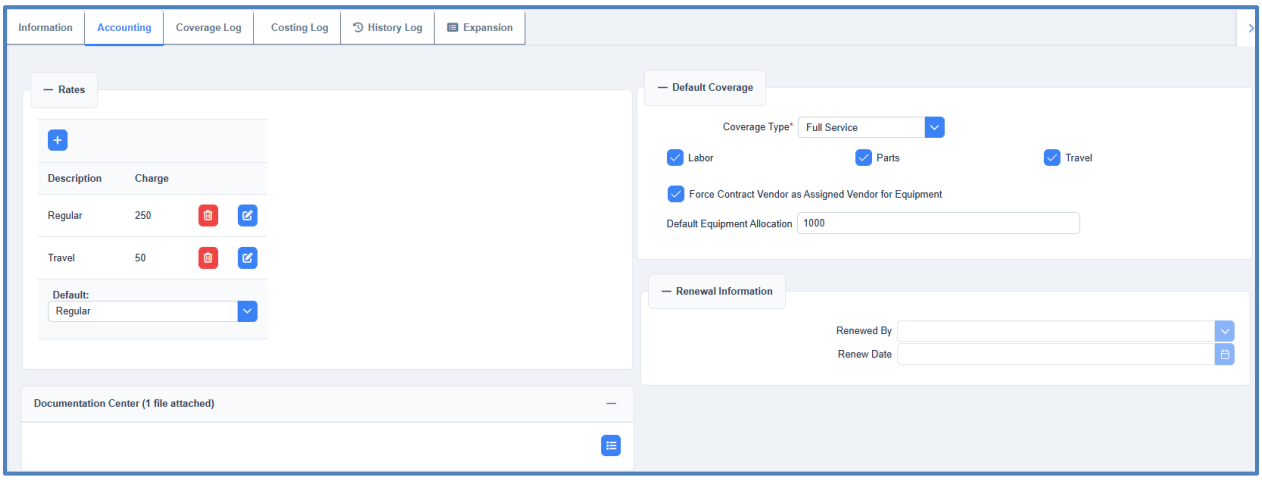
Response type – This drop-down menu determines whether the response time is measured in Hours or Days. The selected option works in conjunction with the value entered in the Response Time field.

Below these settings is a schedule grid displaying each day of the week. By default, selecting a day indicates that the vendor is available for coverage for the full 24 period. If a vendor is not available for the entire day, administrators can clear the checkbox for the applicable day and define a specific coverage schedule. The Start Time field is used to designate when coverage begins and can be entered manually or selected using the calendar/time picker. The Duration (Hours) field is then used to specify how many hours the vendor remains available after the selected start time. This allows organizations to accurately reflect vendor availability and ensure contract coverage is applied correctly.

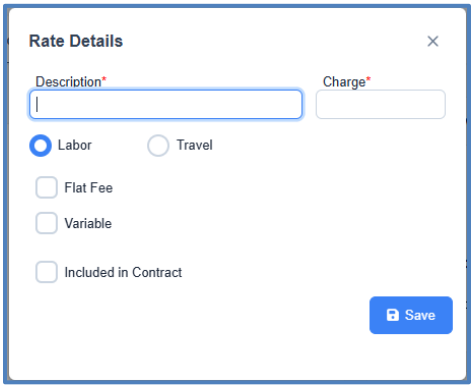


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Accounting Tab



Rates – Setting a Contract's rates monetizes the labor on Contracts. After clicking the plus sign, Users are presented with a popup screen to enter a rate's description, amount, and designate the charge as "Labor" or "Travel". Rates can additionally declare a "Flat Fee", "Variable", and if they are "Included in the Contract". Rates can be added and deleted as needed.



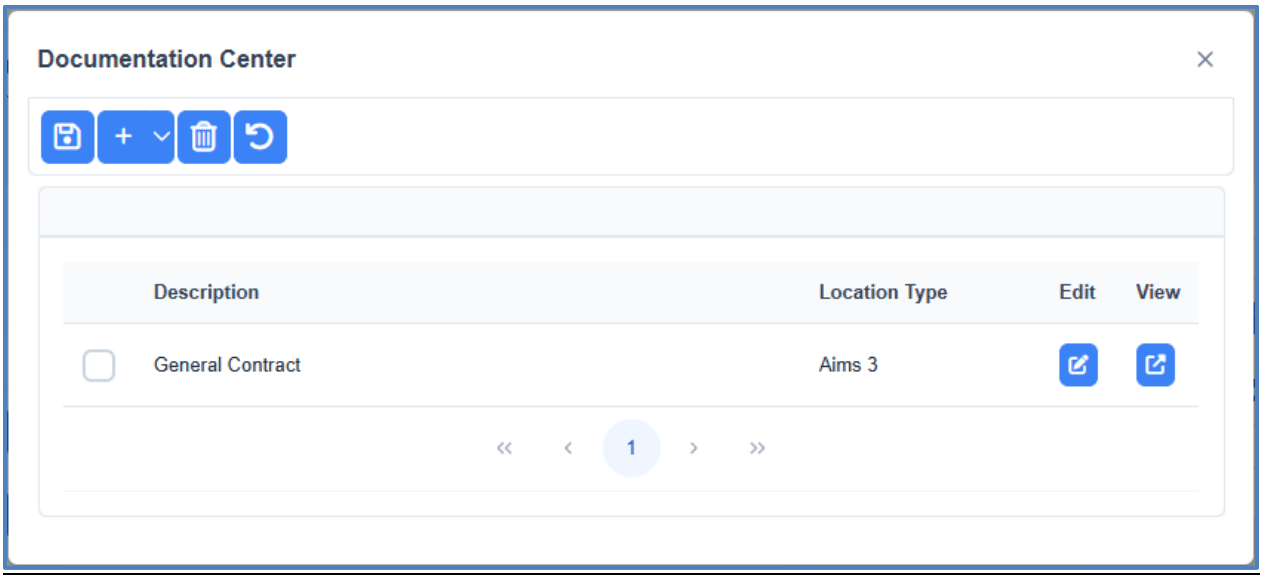
Finally, at the bottom of the grid, Users must declare a default rate. These are based on the rates already entered.

Note: "Default" is a required field. Thus, at least one rate must be entered.

Default Coverage – Sets defaults for the Equipment added to the Coverage Log. This information can be tailored to individual Equipment, if needed.
Coverage Type – Declares how the Equipment is covered. These are set in the Data Managers.
Labor/Parts/Travel – Declares if Labor, Parts, and/or Travel is covered by the Contract.
Force Contract Vendor as Assigned Vendor for Equipment – Will automatically assign the Provider in the General Details as the assigned Vendor on the Equipment record.
Default Equipment Allocation – Sets the default allocation amount on Equipment as they are added.
Renewed By – The AIMS 3 User who renewed the Contract.
Renew Date – The date the Contract was renewed.

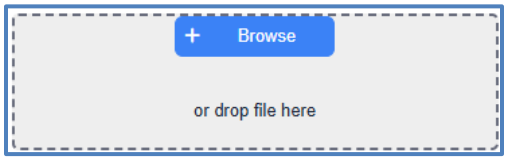
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Documentation Center – Allows Users to attach files to the Contract. Clicking the "List Attachments" button  will bring up a window, listing the current attached files.



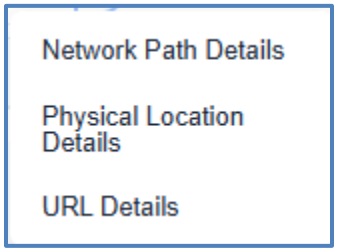
 **Save -** Saves the attachment.

 **New –** Adds a new attachment. When the plus is clicked the window will include a section on the right side to "Browse" for the file or Users can drag and drop the file in the "File Details" section.



Note: On mobile devices, browsing for files will present the user with three options: taking a photo, selecting a photo from the Photo Library, or accessing the devices files application.

Clicking the down arrow will allow users to enter a network path to a local network location, enter a location where the physical file is stored, or enter a hyperlink if the file is stored on an external network.

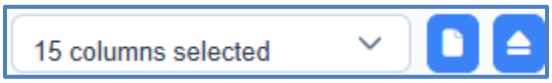


 **Delete –** Deletes the Saved or Unsaved attachment.

 **Undo –** Returns the Unsaved attachment to the previous save point.

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Coverage Log Tab



The Coverage Log displays all Equipment currently covered by the contract, providing a centralized view of assets included in the agreement.

To help manage and review covered equipment, the Coverage Log includes a Column Selector that allows users to choose which fields are displayed in the grid. This makes it easier to focus on the information most relevant to their workflow.
Users can also utilize the Export function to export Coverage Log data for reporting, analysis, or record-keeping purposes.

For easier viewing and navigation, the Pop Out View option opens the Coverage Log in a separate window. This can be especially useful when reviewing large numbers of equipment records or when working with multiple screens.

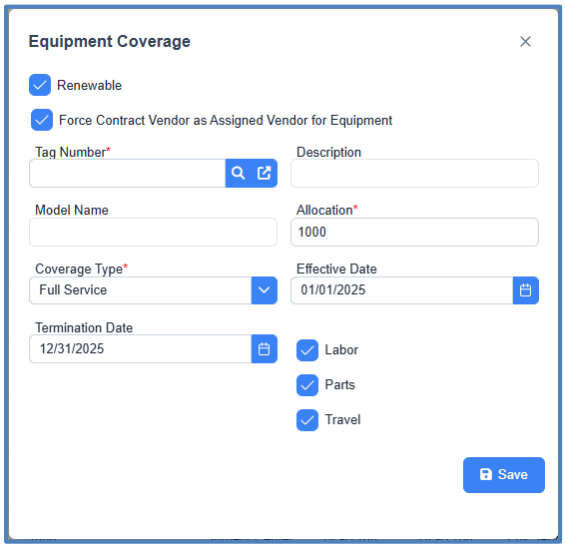
The Coverage Log serves as a quick reference for verifying which equipment is covered under a contract and helps ensure contract coverage is accurately maintained over time.



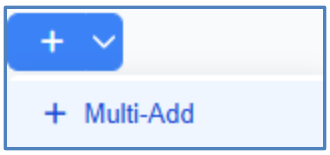
New – Adds Equipment to the Contract. Clicking the plus sign will activate a popup window to enter Equipment. The defaults set in the Administration section mentioned above will automatically fill in. Using the Tag Number field, Users can either manually type in the Tag Number or use the Find function to locate the required record.

Note: Users should always review the defaults to ensure accuracy!

When all the fields are set the User clicks the “Save” button in the lower right corner.



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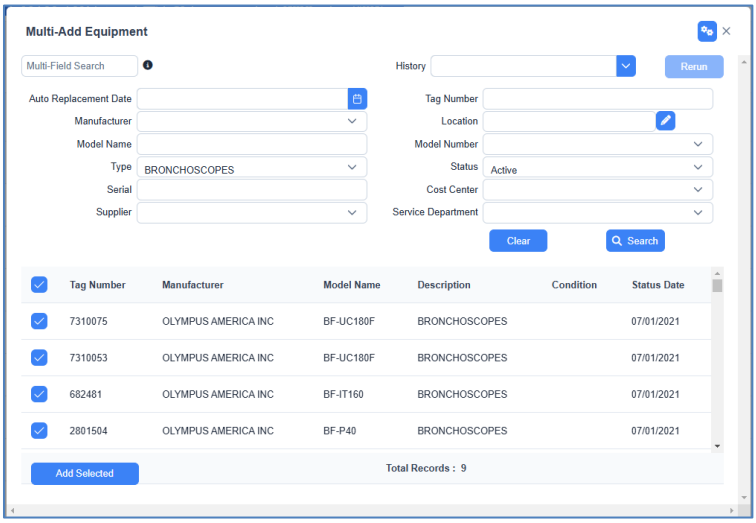


Multi-Add – The Multi-Add feature allows users to add multiple equipment records to a contract at the same time, eliminating the need to add each piece of equipment individually.

Clicking Multi-Add opens a search window similar to the Equipment Find screen. Users can enter search criteria using the available fields to locate the equipment they want to add to the contract.

Once the search results are displayed, a checkbox appears next to each equipment record, allowing users to select one, multiple, or all matching records. For added convenience, a Select All checkbox is available at the top of the grid to quickly choose every record returned by the search.

After making the desired selections, users can add all selected equipment to the contract in a single action. This feature is especially useful when setting up new contracts that cover large groups of equipment, helping reduce data entry time and improving efficiency while ensuring all applicable assets are included under the contract.



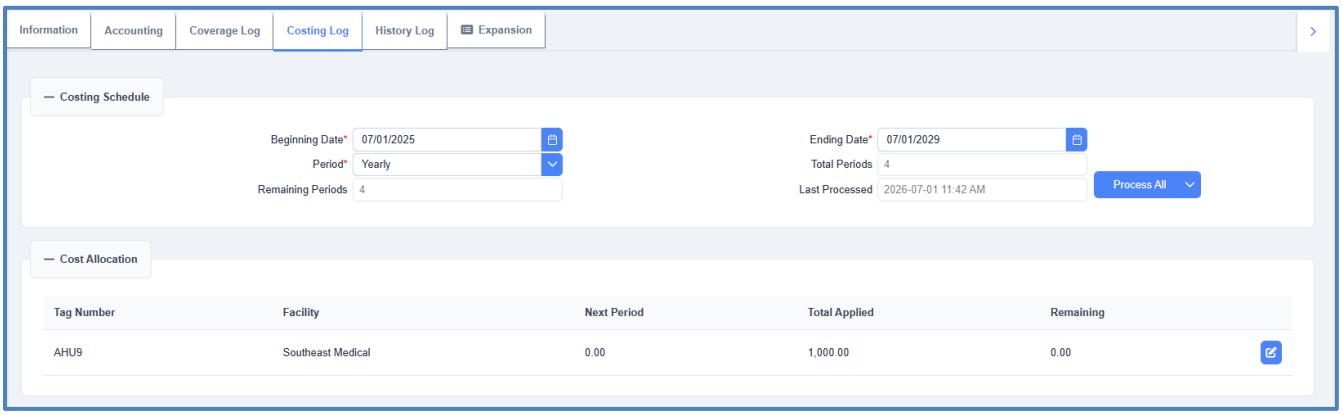
After the User clicks “Add Selected”, they will be presented with another popup where they can review and refine the defaults. Clicking the “Save” button will add the Equipment to the Contract.

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Costing Log Tab

Contract Costing is used to track and analyze the costs associated with a specific contract throughout its lifecycle. By monitoring labor, travel, parts, and other related expenses, organizations can gain a better understanding of the total cost of maintaining the agreement and ensure contract funds are being used appropriately.

As costs are applied to the contract, AIMS3 records the activity and provides visibility into where expenses are occurring and who is responsible for those charges. This information can help organizations manage vendor agreements, monitor spending, identify cost trends, and support budgeting efforts.



Costing Scheule – The Costing Schedule section allows users to create a schedule that automatically distributes contract costs across all equipment listed in the Coverage Log. This helps organizations spread contract expenses over time and accurately allocate costs to covered assets.

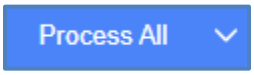
Beginning and Ending Date - Users can define when the costing schedule begins and ends by selecting the appropriate Beginning Date and Ending Date. These dates determine the period during which contract costs will be distributed.

Period - The Period drop-down menu controls how often costs are allocated to the covered equipment. Available options may include Weekly, Monthly, Quarterly, Yearly, or One-Time distributions. Selecting the appropriate period ensures contract costs are assigned according to the organization's financial and reporting requirements.

Remaining Periods - The Remaining Periods field displays the number of distribution periods that are still scheduled to occur. This provides a quick way to monitor how much of the costing schedule remains and helps users track the progress of the contract allocation process.

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Last Processed - The Last Processed field displays the most recent date the costing schedule was processed for the contract. This information helps users verify that the schedule is running as expected and provides visibility into when contract costs were last distributed to the covered equipment.



The Process All button applies the costing schedule to all equipment currently listed in the Coverage Log. When selected, AIMS 3 processes the schedule and distributes contract costs based on the parameters defined within the costing schedule.

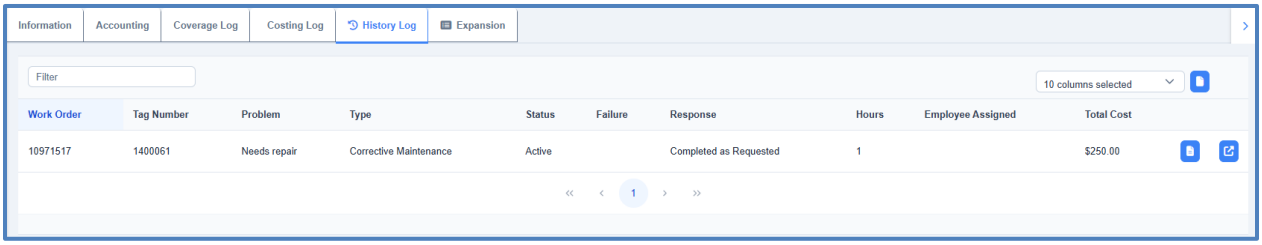
By clicking the down arrow next to the Process All button, users can access additional processing options. One of these options allows users to process only newly added equipment that has been added to the contract since the last costing schedule was processed.

This option is especially useful when new equipment has been added to an existing contract and users want to apply the costing schedule only to those records without reprocessing equipment that has already been included. This helps maintain accurate cost allocations while reducing unnecessary processing.

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History Log Tab

The **History Log** provides a record of all Work Orders that have applied costs to the contract. This gives users visibility into contract activity and helps track how contract funds have been utilized over time.



The information displayed in the History Log can be customized using the **Column Selector**, allowing users to choose which fields are shown in the grid. This makes it easier to focus on the data most relevant to their workflow and reporting needs.

Users can also export the History Log for further analysis, record-keeping, or reporting purposes.

Each Work Order listed in the History Log includes two quick-access options:
View Report allows users to open and review the details of the specific Work Order without leaving the contract record.

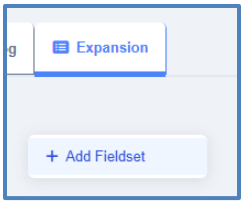
Go To takes users directly to the associated Work Order, making it easy to review labor, parts, costs, notes, and other information related to the contract activity.

The History Log serves as an audit trail for contract-related costs and provides a convenient way to review how the contract has been used throughout its lifecycle.

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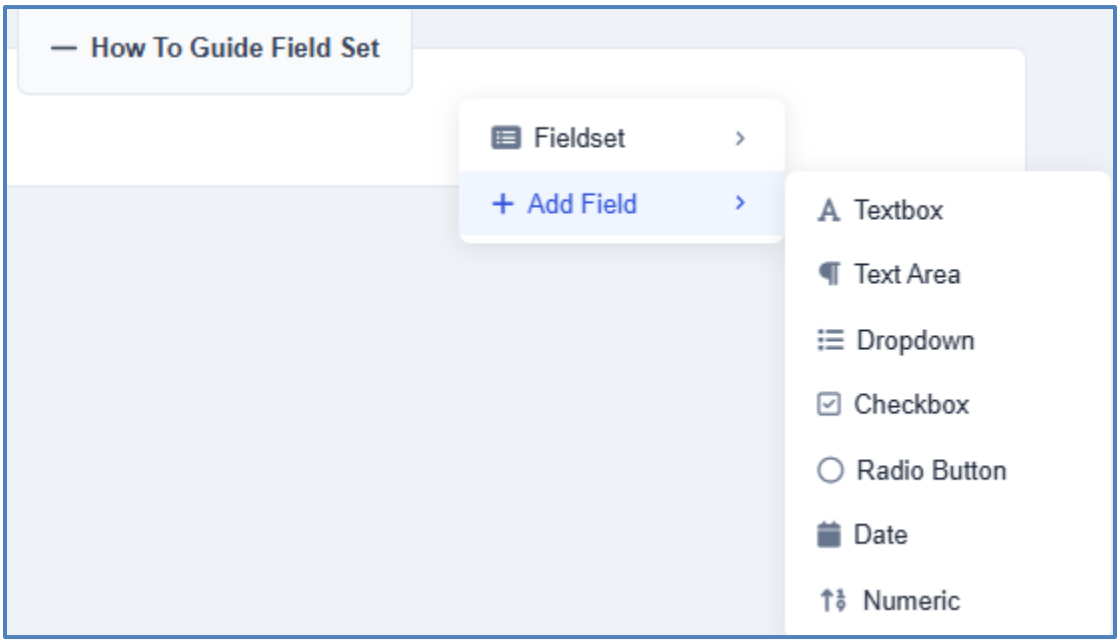
Expansion Tab

No CMMS system includes every field an organization may need. The Expansion tab provides flexibility to create custom field sets and fields that support your unique workflows, documentation requirements, and reporting needs. Although custom fields are created within the Expansion tab, they do not have to remain there. Fields can be moved to the record header to make important information more visible and easily accessible.



To create a custom field set, right-click within the grey area below the tab bar and select Add Field set. Enter a name for the field set and click OK. Field sets help organize custom fields into logical sections, making information easier to manage and review.

After a field set has been created, right-click on the field set name to access additional customization options. Users can rename or delete the field set as needed. Selecting Add Field allows administrators to create custom fields within the field set and choose the appropriate field type, such as text, date, number, checkbox, drop-down list, and more. Individual custom fields can also be edited or deleted by right-clicking within the field area.



When editing a custom field, administrators can designate the field as Required, ensuring users must complete it before saving the record. Once fields are added to the header, they can be rearranged to match organizational preferences and workflow requirements.

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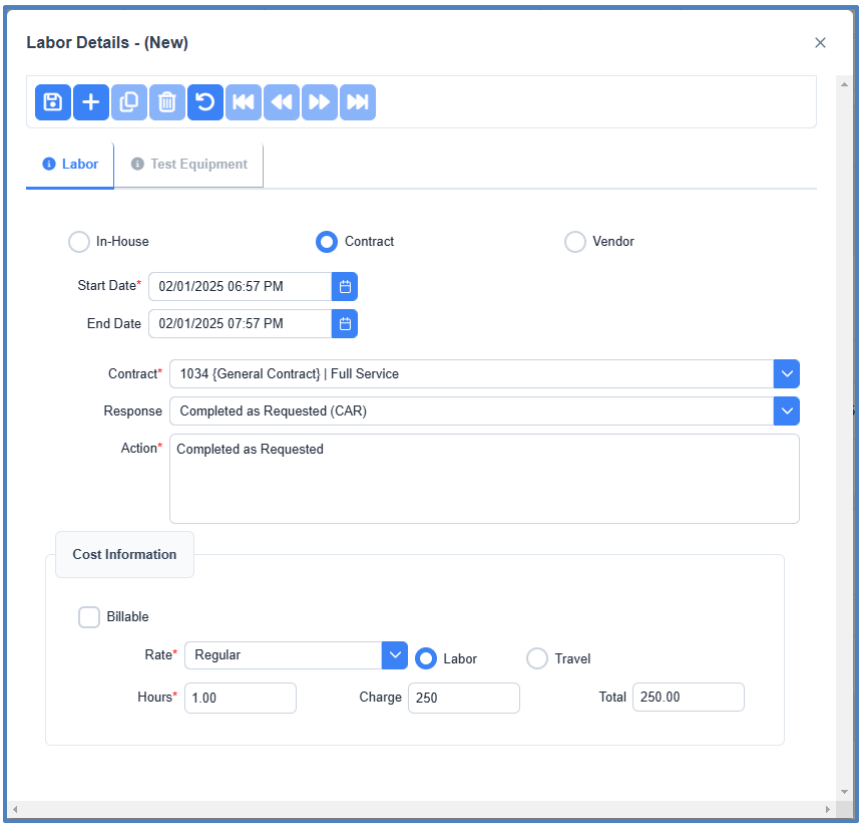
Contracts and Work Orders

Labor and Parts costs from Work Orders can be applied directly to a contract, allowing organizations to accurately track expenses associated with vendor agreements and service coverage.

When entering a Labor or Parts cost on a Work Order, users can select the Contract radio button within the cost entry window. This allows the user to choose the appropriate contract from a list of available contracts.

Once a contract is selected, the system automatically populates the Rate field using the default rate defined on the contract. If necessary, the user can select a different contract rate before saving the transaction.

After the cost is saved, it becomes associated with the selected contract and is automatically recorded in the contract's History Log. This provides a complete record of contract-related activity, allowing users to review labor, travel, and parts costs that have been charged against the agreement over time.

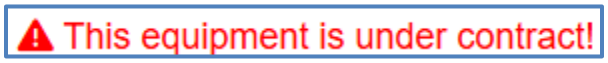


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Contract Critical Messages

When equipment is covered by a contract, AIMS 3 displays a Critical Message in the record's Notification Center to alert users that contract coverage exists. This notification provides quick visibility into important contract information without requiring users to manually search for the associated contract.

The Critical Message is interactive and can be clicked to view additional details. Initially, the message displays key information such as the Contract Provider and the contract's Effective and Termination Dates.



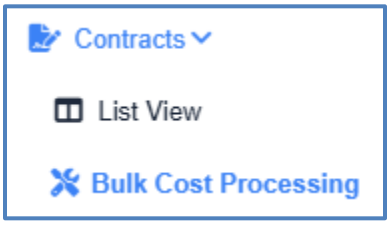
Clicking on the contract information expands the message to display additional contract details, giving users a more complete view of the agreement directly from the Equipment record.
A **Go To** button is also available within the expanded message, allowing users to navigate directly to the Contract record. This provides quick access to contract details, coverage information, rates, costing history, and other related information without having to perform a separate search.



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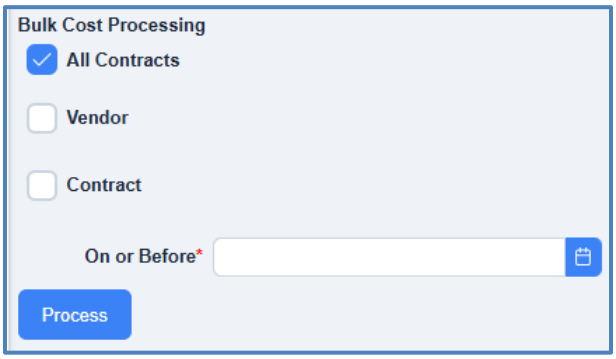
Bulk Contract Processing

To apply contract costing to multiple records at once, AIMS 3 provides a Bulk Costing utility within the Contracts menu. This feature allows organizations to process contract costing schedules for multiple contracts simultaneously, reducing the need to process each contract individually.



To begin, select the desired Costing Type and enter an On or Before date. The date is used to determine which costing schedules are eligible for processing based on their scheduled distribution dates.

After the required information has been entered, click the Process button. AIMS 3 will process all qualifying costing schedules that meet the selected criteria and apply the appropriate contract costs to the covered equipment.



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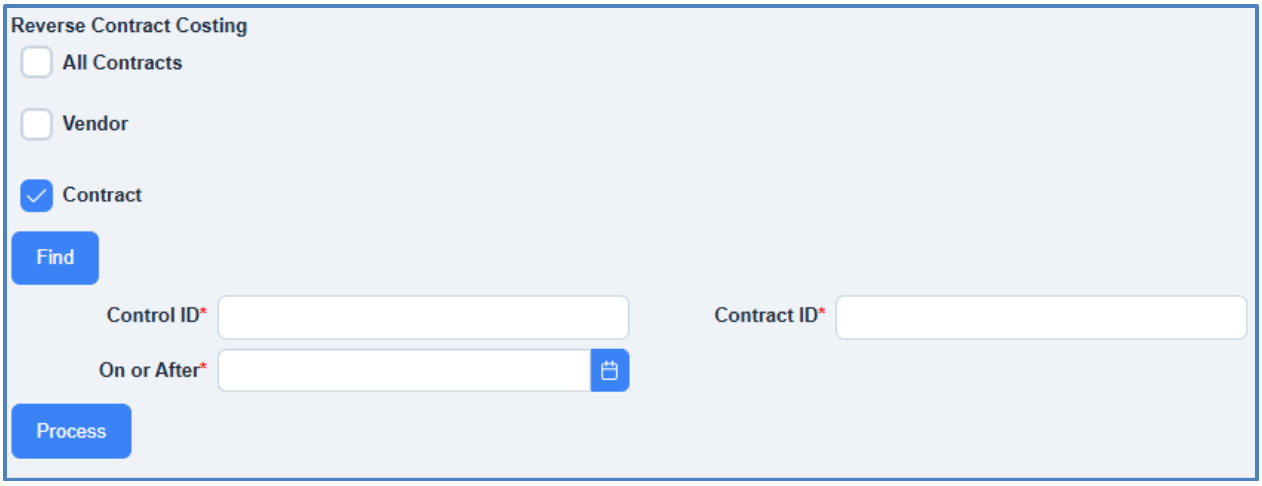
Reverse Contract Costing

If contract costing needs to be reversed, AIMS 3 provides a Reverse Contract Costing utility within the Contracts menu. This feature allows users to remove previously processed contract costing entries when adjustments or corrections are required.

As a safety measure, the screen defaults to Contract, helping ensure users are reversing costs from the correct source. Users must complete the required fields, including the contract and applicable processing criteria, before proceeding.

Once the necessary information has been entered, click the Process button to reverse the selected contract costing transactions. The system will remove the previously applied costs and update the contract records accordingly.

The Reverse Contract Costing utility should be used carefully, as reversing costs can impact contract balances, costing schedules, and financial reporting. This feature provides organizations with a controlled method for correcting processing errors and maintaining accurate contract cost records.



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Conclusion

Contracts represent legally binding agreements between two or more parties and play an important role in managing vendor relationships, service coverage, and associated costs. The Contracts module provides a centralized location to store contract information, monitor agreement details, track covered equipment, and record labor, travel, and parts costs applied against each contract. By maintaining contract activity within AIMS 3, organizations can better manage vendor performance, monitor contract utilization, and maintain accurate financial records throughout the life of the agreement.

The Contracts module also provides visibility into contract coverage directly from Equipment and Work Order records, helping staff quickly determine when an asset is covered by a service agreement and access relevant contract information when needed.

If your organization requires additional assistance with configuring, managing, or utilizing the Contracts module, Phoenix Data Systems offers consulting, implementation assistance, and training services to ensure your team gets the most value from AIMS 3. For additional information, please contact our sales Department or Project Managers for more information.

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Appendix

To support your learning, we have created a step-by-step video guide that visually walks you through the entire process. Simply click the link below to visit our YouTube channel, where you can watch the full Contracts component Course of tutorials at your own pace. This is a great way to follow along, review key steps, and build confidence with the workflow as you learn.

Contracts Component

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